



NASA releases Europa wishlist

As it gears up to launch a mission to Jupiter's icy moon, NASA has made public a list of fancy gear it wants to take to Europa <http://dgit.in/19Buv3m>

Yahoo mail shuts in China

Yahoo's email service in China is shut down and it has asked users to transfer accounts to Alibaba's Alimail. Read more here: <http://dgit.in/1d8ePcL>

Industry Connect

Memory matters

Who hasn't heard of Kingston memory and storage devices? Undoubtedly, a lot of us here in India have. Probably that's why duplicate or fake products bearing a close resemblance to Kingston drives have flooded the markets, recently. We interact with **Vishal Parekh, Marketing Director - India, Kingston Technology**, and find out how the company's dealing with this specific problem, and other product highlights in an exclusive interview. Excerpts follow:

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Q Apart from the HyperX 3K (and its various capacities), there isn't any other model in the Enthusiast SSD lineup. With competition having a diverse range in the enthusiast segment, why does Kingston not have variety there?

Kingston chooses not to focus on any specified consumer groups, and we don't really believe in following trends set by our competitors. Instead, we have a range of SSD in different segments – from enterprise to enthusiast. You shall notice that Kingston always has something to offer various users. We put a lot of efforts into different products for different consumers, and we believe we have an impressive variety of SSD. For instance, the V300 is for regular consumers, the HyperX 3K ones are for enthusiasts, and the E100 SSD is for enterprises. One thing that's for sure, however, is that all our SSD have excellent quality, high speed, and great performance.

Q We are seeing newer players in the SSD controller segment recently. Does Kingston have any plans to move away from the SandForce controller in the near future?

No, we don't have any plans at the moment to move away from the SandForce controller.

Q The HyperX RAM lineup is quite interesting. Could you give us an idea of the adoption rate of enthusiast RAM, as in what

percentage of RAM sales includes HyperX RAM in India?

Yes, our HyperX memory modules are available in various designs and specifications, which make them ideal for the gaming and enthusiast segment. You'll find modules for home theatre systems, gaming rigs and overclockers in the HyperX range. In fact, HyperX is our most premium line of products and are immensely popular across the globe. India is no exception, as HyperX have always been popular among gamers and enthusiasts, especially HyperX blu. Kingston will focus on researching and continue bringing the high-performance memory products into the Indian market to fulfill consumers need.

Q Could you tell us about your Data Traveler encrypted pen drives and its security features?

Kingston's range of encrypted, secure flash drives provide the highest level of data protection that meets specific agency directives like TAA and FIPS compliance and are ideal for corporates or government use. We have 6 varieties of secure USB flash drives and in various capacities. While each of the flash drives is unique, the qualities they have in common are that they are durable, waterproof, easy to use, have hardware-based encryption, and come with a five year warranty. The hardware based encryption makes these flash drives a better option over the software based ones.



Vishal Parekh, Marketing Director - India, Kingston Technology

Q What is Kingston doing about the 'fake Kingston pen drives' being sold on the streets in Mumbai and other places? These drives offer huge capacities at lower prices and they come with the Kingston branding.

The concern around fake pen drives is more of a law-and-order situation in the country. What we are doing right now is to create awareness about purchasing genuine Kingston products through authorized distribution channel and dealers. Through our channel partners' initiatives, social media, and EDMs, we keep consumers informed about the benefits purchasing from authorized distribution. Consumers can also visit our website to verify if the Kingston product they've purchased is authentic. (http://www.kingston.com/en/support/product_verification)

Q At CES you showcased a first-of-its-kind 1TB pen drive. Was that just a proof-of-concept or do you actually expect demand for pen drives with hundreds of gigabytes of storage to increase?

We realize that the 1TB capacity flash drive will attract a group of more niche, enthusiastic consumers. But we do believe that in time, the demand for high performance flash drives with greater capacities will increase. **Q**